

## TRAINING REPORT

# Acceptance

*Personal workbook for Sam · developing club golfer (hcp 24.0)*

### Sam

Score on Acceptance: 5.6/10

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5.6 / 10 **A WORKING AREA**

## Why acceptance wins strokes

You sit at 5.6 on acceptance — sometimes you shake off a bad shot, sometimes it drags into the next three. At hcp 24 that's costly: one chunked wedge or topped fairway wood can snowball into a triple. The good news? This is your fastest win. Learn to reset in twenty seconds and you'll stop bleeding those extra strokes.

### WHAT YOUR SCORE MEANS

A 5.6 is honest middle ground for a developing club golfer. You're not falling apart, but you're not reliable yet — good rounds hold, tough ones spiral. Most players around hcp 24 sit right here.

### WHAT YOUR HANDICAP MEANS HERE

At hcp 24 the damage usually comes after a mistake, not the mistake itself: a topped 3-wood, a bladed chip, a three-putt from 20 feet. The typical fault is forcing the recovery — going for the hero shot while still angry. Your fastest win is simply resetting before the next swing.

#### WHAT IT GAINS YOU

Get acceptance from wobbly to solid and you'll immediately protect scores. That double after a bad drive becomes a bogey; the round that used to fall apart on hole 11 holds together. For a hcp 24 player that's easily three or four strokes and a lot more enjoyment.

#### HOW TO USE IT AS A WEAPON

Your ally shows up right after the miss: instead of grabbing a club and firing, you take one breath, name the lie, and play the sensible shot back to the fairway. That single pause turns a potential triple into a bogey — and keeps your head clear for the rest of the round.

*Leave this and one bad hole keeps costing you two or three more — the frustration follows you to the next tee, and a decent round quietly slips away.*

#### HOW TO USE THIS REPORT

Treat this like any swing change: one read-through won't rewire you. Pick one or two exercises a week and repeat them — that's how a reset becomes automatic under pressure. The mental game grooves exactly like a takeaway: slow at first, then second nature. Small, steady reps beat one big effort.

→ **Grab your phone and pin one training moment into your calendar this week.**

#### THE ANGLES AND EXERCISES

*These are a menu, not a checklist. Pick one or two that appeal to you each week — doing everything at once backfires and just adds pressure. Small steps you actually repeat win over grand plans you drop. Choose what fits your week.*

## 1. The body first

Before your mind untangles a bad shot, your body reacts — tight shoulders, quick breathing, a fast angry walk. Resetting the body first calms the mind almost automatically. For a hcp 24 player, this is the simplest entry point because it needs no thinking, just doing.

### ON THE COURSE · Exhale and drop shoulders

20 sec · every round, after each bad shot

*Why — One slow breath physically breaks the tension loop — thirty seconds now saves you the next rushed swing.*

1. Right after a bad shot, stop where you stand. 2. Breathe out slowly through your mouth, longer than you breathe in. 3. Let your shoulders drop and unclench your grip on the club. 4. Only then start walking. Do this on any hole where the ball goes sideways.

### AT HOME · Slow-breath rehearsal

5 min · 2× per week

*Why — Groove the breath at home and it shows up on the course when you actually need it.*

1. Sit quietly and picture your last topped shot or three-putt. 2. Feel the frustration rise. 3. Breathe out slowly for six seconds, shoulders dropping. 4. Notice the tension ease. 5. Repeat five times, each with a different bad shot in mind.

### DRILL · Walking-pace reset

10 min · 1× per week

*Why — Slowing your walk after a mistake keeps adrenaline from bleeding into your next swing.*

On the range, hit five deliberately bad shots. After each, walk ten slow, even steps to your bag before the next ball. Feel how a calm pace lowers the urge to rush.

*Tip — After a bad shot, unclench your grip first — tight hands are your body still holding the anger.*

*Tip — Match your walking speed to a calm playing partner's; a slow pace tells your body it's fine.*

## 2. The twenty seconds

Emotion needs an outlet, but only a short one. A fixed twenty-second routine after the ball gives frustration somewhere to go, then closes the door. This suits a hcp 24 player because it turns a vague 'stay calm' into a clear, repeatable habit.

### ON THE COURSE · The twenty-second ritual

20 sec · every round, after mistakes

*Why — A fixed routine gives your anger a short exit — twenty seconds now stops it hijacking the next hole.*

1. After a poor shot, allow yourself a reaction for a few seconds — a mutter, a head-shake, fine. 2. Then look up and pick a spot ahead. 3. Take one breath. 4. Say 'done' to yourself. 5. Start planning the next shot. Whole thing under twenty seconds.

### AT HOME · Design your reset

8 min · 1× per week

*Why — Building your own routine now means it's ready and automatic before the pressure hits.*

1. Write down what you'll do in your twenty seconds: allow reaction, breathe, a trigger word like 'done' or 'next'. 2. Say it out loud a few times. 3. Picture a bad shot and run the full sequence in your head. 4. Adjust until it feels natural to you.

### DRILL · Trigger-word reps

10 min · 1× per week

*Why — Repeating your cut-off word ties it to a calm state, so it works when you're rattled.*

On the putting green, miss a few short putts on purpose. After each, run your twenty-second routine and finish with your trigger word before the next putt. Ten reps.

*Tip — Pick one short trigger word and never change it — consistency makes it fire under pressure.*

*Tip — If twenty seconds passes and you're still fuming, that's a signal to breathe once more, not to swing.*

### 3. Process over outcome

You can't change where the ball ended up — but you fully own the next decision. Shifting attention from the result to the quality of the next choice is where scores get saved. For a hcp 24 player, this often means resisting the hero recovery.

#### ON THE COURSE · Name the smart shot

30 sec · a few holes per round

*Why — Choosing the sensible play instead of the hero shot turns triples into bogeys — that's real strokes back.*

1. After a bad shot, stand behind the ball. 2. Say out loud the lie: 'in the rough, 130 out, uphill'. 3. Ask: what's the shot that gets me safely back in play? 4. Pick that club, not the risky one. 5. Commit fully to that decision.

#### AT HOME · Replay the decision

6 min · after each round

*Why — Reviewing decisions, not results, trains you to judge yourself on choices you can actually control.*

1. Think back to one bad hole from your last round. 2. Ignore the score — ask only: was my next-shot decision smart? 3. If yes, that's a win regardless of result. 4. If no, picture the smarter choice. 5. Note the pattern in how you recover.

#### DRILL · Recovery-shot practice

12 min · 1× per week

*Why — Practising the safe punch-out makes it feel natural, so you'll actually choose it under pressure.*

On the range, imagine you're in trouble. Hit ten low, controlled shots with a 7- or 8-iron aimed just back to an imaginary fairway — not for distance, for position.

*Tip — After a miss, ask 'what's the smart shot?' not 'how do I make up for it?' — different question, better answer.*

*Tip — A good decision after a bad shot is a success — score it as a win, even if the ball misbehaves.*

## 4. The inner voice

How you talk to yourself after a mistake decides how long it lingers. 'Idiot, you always do that' keeps the anger alive; a flat, factual sentence lets it pass. Many hcp 24 players don't even notice this running commentary — spotting it is half the fix.

### ON THE COURSE · **Swap to a fact**

15 sec · as needed each round

*Why — A neutral sentence starves the frustration — try it once and notice how fast your head clears.*

1. Catch the harsh thought after a bad shot ('terrible, you always chunk it'). 2. Replace it with a plain fact: 'that one came up short'. 3. No blame, no judgement, just what happened. 4. Then move to your next shot. Do this whenever you hear yourself getting sharp.

### AT HOME · **Rewrite your self-talk**

7 min · 1× per week

*Why — Writing calmer sentences now gives you ready-made replacements for the heat of the moment.*

1. Write down three things you typically say to yourself after a bad shot. 2. Beside each, write a neutral, factual version. 3. Read the neutral ones aloud a few times. 4. Picture the bad shot and pair it with the calm sentence.

### DRILL · **Catch-and-name reps**

8 min · 1× per week

*Why — Repeatedly catching harsh self-talk builds the awareness you need to change it live.*

On the range, after every mishit, immediately say one neutral sentence out loud about the shot. Ten mishits, ten factual statements. No insults allowed.

*Tip — Talk to yourself the way you'd talk to a mate playing badly — you'd never call them an idiot.*

*Tip — Notice the word 'always' or 'never' — it's a red flag that your inner voice has stopped being factual.*

## 5. The bigger picture

One bad shot feels huge in the moment, but your score is a sum of eighteen holes, not one snapshot. Zooming out shrinks the mistake back to its real size. For a hcp 24 player, remembering there are plenty of holes left keeps one bad swing from becoming a bad round.

### ON THE COURSE · Holes left, not gone

20 sec · after any blow-up hole

*Why — Reminding yourself of the holes still to come stops one blow-up hole from sinking the whole card.*

1. After a bad hole, glance at your card. 2. Say how many holes are still to play: 'twelve left'. 3. Remind yourself: 'this is one hole of eighteen'. 4. Set a small target for the next stretch — bogey the next three. 5. Move on.

### AT HOME · Zoom-out reflection

5 min · after each round

*Why — Seeing that your worst holes were a small slice of the round rebalances how big mistakes really feel.*

1. Take your last scorecard. 2. Circle your two worst holes. 3. Now look at the other sixteen. 4. Notice how much went fine. 5. Remind yourself: the round was decided by the whole, not those two moments.

### DRILL · Three-hole targets

full round · 1× per practice round

*Why — Breaking the round into small chunks keeps one bad hole from spilling into the next three.*

On your next practice round, split the course into six blocks of three holes. Give each block its own small target. When a hole goes wrong, focus only on finishing that block well.

*Tip — When a hole falls apart, ask 'will this matter on the 18th tee?' — usually far less than it feels.*

*Tip — Keep a rough par-total in your head, not each hole's disaster — the sum is what counts.*

### INSIGHT

Better players aren't calmer by nature — they just spend less time being upset. Watch a low-handicapper after a bad shot: the reaction is often sharper than yours, but it's over in seconds. They've decided in advance that frustration gets a short window, then it's done. The skill isn't feeling nothing; it's shortening the recovery. That's exactly what your twenty-second routine trains, and it's fully learnable.

### FROM THE GAME

Picture a club medal. You're playing steady, then top a fairway wood into the trees on 12. The old you tries the impossible gap between two trunks, catches wood, and walks off with a seven. The new you takes a breath, names the lie, chips out sideways to the fairway, wedges on, two-putts for a bogey. Same bad shot — but one costs three strokes and your mood, the other costs one. That gap is acceptance.

#### OBSERVATION POINT · WATCH SOMEONE ELSE

*You're playing in company anyway — watching how a partner handles a bad shot teaches you what to spot in yourself, for free.*

#### GOOD ACCEPTANCE SHOWS IN

Watch a player who reacts briefly, then breathes, looks ahead, and calmly picks a sensible recovery. Their walking pace stays even and their next shot isn't rushed or angry.

#### WEAK ACCEPTANCE SHOWS IN

Notice the player who slams the club, mutters all the way to the ball, walks fast and stiff, then fires an aggressive hero shot straight into more trouble.

#### REFLECTION & AI COACHING

*Copy a prompt below into an AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude) to think it through further yourself — a sounding board that always has time.*

##### STARTER PROMPT — COPY & PASTE

I'm a developing club golfer around hcp 24. When I hit a bad shot — a topped fairway wood or a chunked chip — the frustration follows me and I often make it worse on the next shot or two, sometimes turning a bogey into a triple. It clears eventually but too slowly. What's one practical way to shorten my recovery so I move on faster?

##### DIG DEEPER — 1

After a bad hole I tend to try a risky hero recovery while I'm still annoyed. How can I train myself to choose the safe shot instead in that moment?

##### DIG DEEPER — 2

I've noticed my inner voice gets harsh after mistakes ('you always chunk it'). What are simple, factual sentences I could use to replace that talk on the course?

#### YOUR PLAN FOR THE COMING WEEKS

A realistic four-week build from body reset to full round application.

|               |                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Week 1</b> | <b>BODY RESET</b> · ±20 min/week<br>Use the exhale-and-drop-shoulders reset after every bad shot on the course; do the slow-breath rehearsal twice at home.             |
| <b>Week 2</b> | <b>TWENTY-SECOND ROUTINE</b> · ±20 min/week<br>Design your reset at home, add a trigger word, and run the twenty-second ritual after mistakes on a few holes.           |
| <b>Week 3</b> | <b>SMART DECISIONS</b> · ±30 min/week<br>On the course, name the lie and pick the safe shot; replay decisions after the round and practise recovery shots once.         |
| <b>Week 4</b> | <b>VOICE AND PERSPECTIVE</b> · ±30 min/week<br>Swap harsh self-talk for facts on the course, use 'holes left' after blow-ups, and combine everything over a full round. |

#### ON THE COURSE — BEFORE, DURING, AFTER

##### BEFORE THE ROUND

- Decide your trigger word for today before the first tee.
- Take three slow breaths on the range to set a calm pace.
- Remind yourself: bad shots will happen, my job is the reset.

##### DURING

- After each miss, breathe out and drop your shoulders first.
- Name the lie out loud before choosing your recovery club.
- After a blow-up hole, count the holes still to play.

##### AFTER THE ROUND

- Circle your two worst holes and see the round's whole picture.
- Ask if your recovery decisions were smart, not just the results.
- Note how quickly you reset after mistakes this round.

→ This round, breathe out and drop your shoulders after every single bad shot.

#### QUESTIONS TO ASK YOURSELF

*Which bad shot did I recover from fastest, and what helped?*

*Did I try any hero recoveries while still annoyed today?*

*How did my inner voice sound after mistakes — harsh or factual?*

#### HOW YOU KNOW IT'S WORKING

- ☐ Ran my twenty-second reset on at least five holes.
- ☐ Chose the safe recovery shot at least three times.
- ☐ Caught and swapped one harsh thought for a fact.
- ☐ No single bad hole dragged into the next three.

→ Pick just one exercise this week and run it every bad shot — that's how it sticks.

*It happened. Breathe. Next shot.*

YOUR MANTRA

#### YOUR COURSE CUE

*Breathe out, drop your shoulders, name the lie, play on.*